

2014 A-level Paper 2

Suggested Answer Scheme (revised 4/8)

1. What are the purposes of the author's opening question? [2]

From the Text	Inference
'How many times have we been told that studying the past helps us understand the present?'	The author is introducing the topic of the passage in the first sentence. (1) The question is a rhetorical one, designed to show how often the link between events in the past and in the present is made. (1) The use of the inclusive 'we' assumed agreement on the part of the reader. (1)

Note: Any 2 out of 3 to get the full marks.

2. In lines 2-4, what similarity does the author see between the effects of the invention of the printing press and the development of the internet? **Use your own words as far as possible.** [1]

From the Text	Possible Paraphrase
...turmoil created... (l.2)	The similarity is that both developments brought about chaos/great unrest. (1) Note: 'caused problems'; 'negative effects' – does not adequately convey the intensity of the forceful words used in the passage.
...the equally seismic effects... (l.4)	

*Note: Some candidates stated that both developments led to greater ease of communication **but** that is not the point that the author is making in the lines the question designates.*

3. Explain what the author means by describing what has happened to English on the web as "the converse" (line 30) of what happened to Latin. **Use your own words as far as possible.** [1]

From the Text	Possible Paraphrase
...new texts were often produced in contemporary languages, which fatally undermined the primacy of Latin as the primary language of medieval intellectual discourse. Today, the burgeoning use of English in the web shows the converse of that decline. (l.27-30)	The author means that the fates of the two languages are markedly different and occur in different eras (1), a fact emphasised by the author's use of different tenses to describe each. (<i>the second part is not necessary</i>) Or The rise of English on the internet demonstrates the reverse of the diminishing use of Latin as a common language. (1)

4. In paragraph 5, what parallels does the author draw between the consequences for authors of the printing revolution and contributors to today's internet? **Use your own words as far as possible.** [3]

From the Text	Possible Paraphrase
1) 'named individual gained reward and celebrity ' (l.34) 2) 'threatened by the rise of piracy ' (l.35) 3) 'some authors, rather than enjoying wealth, suffered persecution. ' (l.41-42)	The parallels drawn are that contributors to today's internet 1) achieved recognition/ some form of incentive and fame/ prominence. (1) 2) helpless to have their work illegally duplicated. (1) 3) The authors of both eras, instead of becoming rich, could be subjected to punishment/ punitive measures. (1)

5. In what ways does the author consider the internet "preferable" to television in lines 52-54? **Use your own words as far as possible.** [2]

From the Text	Possible Paraphrase
'Active participation and collaboration with others are crucial' (l.52) 'to being the lone, passive consumers we are with television' (l.53)	The internet is 'preferable' to television as it encourages lively engagement/ involvement and cooperation/ partnership with others (1) rather than how television induces people to be isolated, submissive recipients. (1)

6. Explain the author's use of the word "very" in line 59. [1]

From the Text	Inference
'that the internet's very speed and accessibility lead to over-hasty actions' (l.58-59)	The author's use of 'very' is to show that the internet's speed is indeed beneficial but that same quality of speed facilitates over-hasty actions. (1) Also accepted: The internet's speed is seen as a double-edged sword. (1)

7. In lines 61-66, what does the author suggest are the educational and personal consequences for those who "skim rather than delve"? **Use your own words as far as possible.** [2]

From the Text	Possible Paraphrase
1) ' without real engagement with the content ' (l.63) 2) 'the attendant consolidation of knowledge ' (l.63) 3) ' Equally superficial... are the connections with others. ' (l.64)	The consequences for those who 'skim rather than delve' are that they do not attempt to fully/ genuinely understand/comprehend the material (1) and consequently incorporate it into our understanding of the world. (1) Relationships formed are shallow (1) and companions are conveniently gathered and discarded. (1)

4) 'so-called friends are now amassed in on-line networks and just as easily disposed of'. (l.66)	
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Mark Allocation: 1-2 pts = 1m, 3-4 pts = 2m

8. In paragraph 8, the author claims that "technological advance is always made at the cost of the previous behaviours or dearly-held principles". How does the remainder of the paragraph illustrate her assertion? **Use your own words as far as possible.** [2]

From the Text	Possible Paraphrase
1) 'previous notions of guardedness are disregarded by those members of social networking sites... who readily volunteer personal information...' (l.71-73)	The author illustrates her assertion by demonstrating how past ideas/ concepts of keeping private details secret are now ignored and in place, there is a willing disclosure of individual data. (1)
2) 'This new attitude to privacy was articulated – even encouraged – by the CEO of a major computing company who glibly but presciently said, "You have zero privacy. Get over it." (l.74-75)	There is also endorsement/ support by reputed/ influential individuals/ figures on this novel approach of privacy. (1)

9. In lines 78-81, how confident is the author about future use of the internet by the young? **Use your own words as far as possible.** [2]

From the Text	Possible Paraphrase
'...but most, surely , will have the sense to control rather than be controlled. ' (l.80-81)	The author is optimistic about the young's future use of the internet. (1) This is due to the fact that they will have the awareness to manage the internet rather than be dominated by it. (1)

10. How does the quotation from Zhou Enlai (lines 83-84) support the author's argument earlier in this paragraph? **Use your own words as far as possible.**[1]

From the Text	Possible Paraphrase
'we are too close to its inception to have any meaningful perspective' (i.81-82) ... Zhou Enlai... 'It is too soon to say' (l.83-84)	The quotation echoes the author's point that we are just at the beginning of the internet revolution and it is too early to have any telling/ clear insights/ views on how it will turn out.

11. Using material from paragraphs 2-4 only (lines 5-32), summarise what the author has to say about the changes to book production brought about by the invention of the printing press.

Write your summary in no more than 120 words, not counting the opening words which are printed below. **Use your own words as far as possible.** [8]

After the invention of the printing press...

	From the Text	Possible Paraphrase
a	copies were now uniformly duplicated (l. 11)	books could be reproduced/ replicated consistently/ homogeneously
b	in hitherto undreamed-of numbers (l.11-12)	In unprecedented quantities
c	Books became more portable , (l.12)	Books became easier to transport ,
d	durable (l.12)	lasting
e	and affordable (l.12)	and inexpensive/ cheaply sold ,
f	hence reaching an ever-expanding audience. (l.13)	making them available to the ever-increasing masses/ readers.
g	dissemination of the existing ones approved of by the authorities (l.15-16)	Officially-sanctioned material was printed and distributed ,
h	for the first time it was possible to read all that had been written on a subject (l.17)	allowing every available thought on them to be shared.
i	errors in individual texts and disagreements between texts (l.18-19)	Discrepancies/ Mistakes appeared more often,
j	This creates scepticism towards (l.19)	breeding doubt/ cynicism/ uncertainty ,
k	and even rejection of previously unquestioned schools of thought (l.19-20)	causing them to be challenged rather than accepted indiscriminately,
l	allowing for synthesis and the formulation of new theories (l.20-21)	permitting the combination of old and novel/ original ideas/ concepts
m	the new medium offered scope to include supporting illustration (l. 23)	Printing allowed drawings/ images to be incorporated into books,
n	forerunners of the visual elements of web-pages (l.24)	precursors of the graphical nature of web-pages.
o	new texts by living authors now proliferated (l.25)	Original books by living writers were produced rapidly ,
p	bringing into circulation new ideas (l.25)	introducing novel concepts
q	even heresies (l.26)	and subversive/ unorthodox concepts/ beliefs
r	which proved impossible to suppress completely (l.26)	that were hard to quash/control totally/fully
s	and which threatened the power elite. (l.26-27)	and pressurised the authority.

t	new texts were often produced in contemporary languages (l.27-28)	New books were created in current languages
u	which fatally undermined the primacy of Latin as the language of medieval intellectual discourse (l.28-29)	seriously challenging the pre-eminence of Latin as the language of choice for the knowledge elite.
v	there was a means to keep abreast of new religion and scientific thinking (l.30-31)	There was a way to be informed about current developments in religion and science.
w	to contribute in print to such debates (l.31-32)	and to participate in discussions/ share ideas
x	so that future editions were corrected (l.32)	allowing for more accurate reprints
y	thus creating a new culture of 'feedback' (l.33)	and a practice of sharing opinions/ criticisms/ ideas.

Mark conversion:

1-2 = 1
3-4 = 2
5-6 = 3
7-8 = 4
9-10 = 5
11-12 = 6
13-14 = 7
≥15 = 8

12. Emily Speight generally welcomes the internet but highlights some concerns about its possible effects on individuals and society. How far would you agree with her observations, both for and against the internet, relating your arguments to your own society? [10]

This year's topic was the revolution in communications brought about by the development of the internet, with some backward glances at the previous revolution when the printing press was invented. This topic led to many vigorous and engaging responses to the author's arguments.

Many candidates wrote effectively about the empowering effect the internet was having for 'netizens' and its possible future consequences for the democratic process.

Less optimistically, abuses of the net were highlighted: ill-judged blogs, online gambling and internet fraud were all regularly mentioned, as were concerns that over-reliance on the internet leads to less confident and effective social skills.

Candidates were divided in their overall response to Ms Speight's ideas: many thought her over-optimistic in her championing of the internet, whilst others thought her unnecessarily doom-laden in her anxieties about the future.

Most candidates found plenty to write about by focusing on the main issue of the use and abuse of the internet, but others found less obvious topics to comment fruitfully upon. An example of this was the author's anxiety about future health of libraries: this elicited vigorous rebuttal from a number of candidates who pointed to the creation of new libraries in Singapore and their attendant popularity.